LESSON 8

London Bridge

An old English singing game: two children make a bridge with their arms, and it falls down on whoever is passing under.

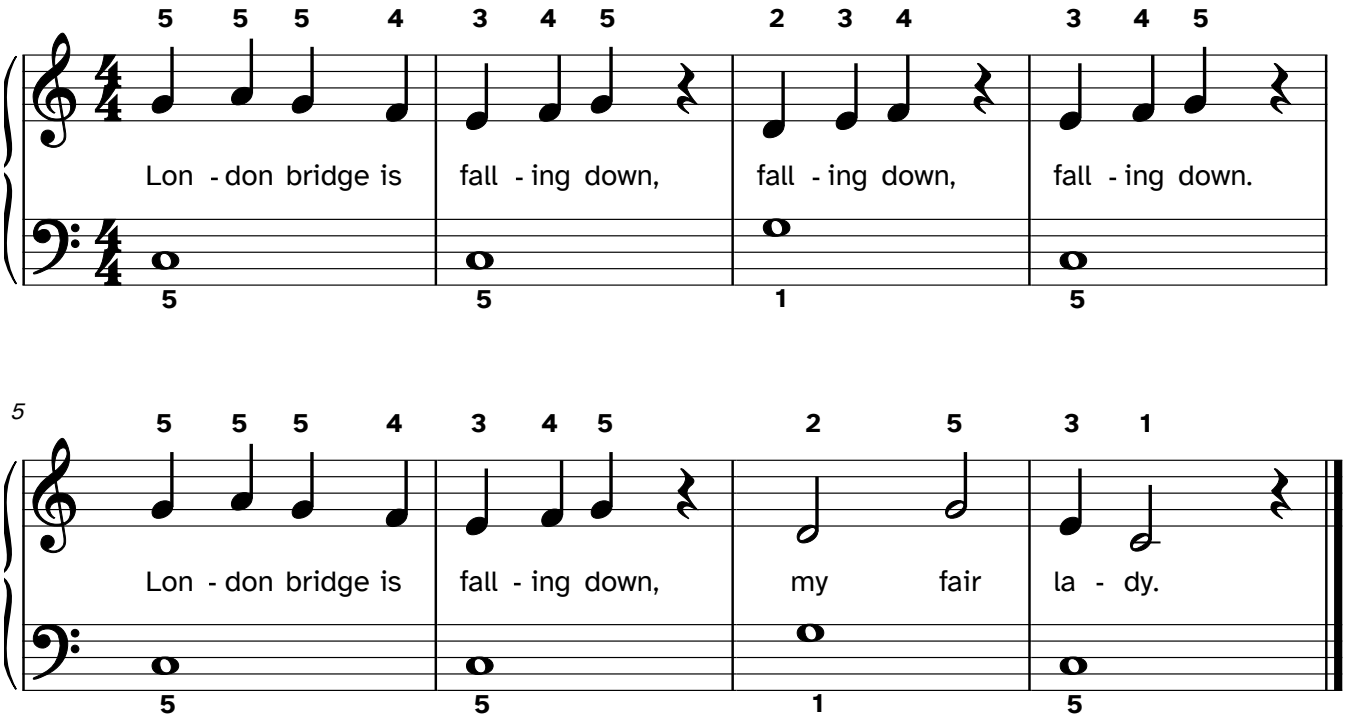
IN THIS SONG **right hand: the tune** **left hand: roots C and G** **rests** **no letters now**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it, then play it with both hands: the right hand has the tune, the left hand holds the root.

Right hand: the C position; on *Lon-don* 5 reaches up to A and straight back. **Left hand:** the root, 5 on low C or the thumb on G (the hands on page 3).



THE WOW MOMENT

☆ **The bridge falls:** on every rest the right hand jumps off the keys, high in the air, and lands back in place for the next bar. The left hand keeps holding its root.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Lifted on every rest** ☐ **Played it with both hands**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

NEW IN THIS SONG

Rests. A crotchet rest is one beat of silence: count it, but don't play. **A second root, G.** The left hand plays C or G at the start of each bar, whichever the tune leans on. **No letters now:** read the notes from the staff.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones, and on a rest's grey number lift your hands.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

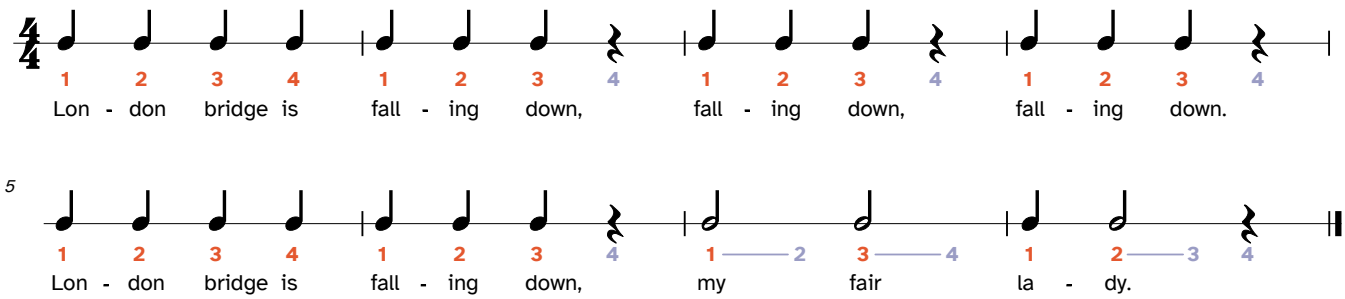
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

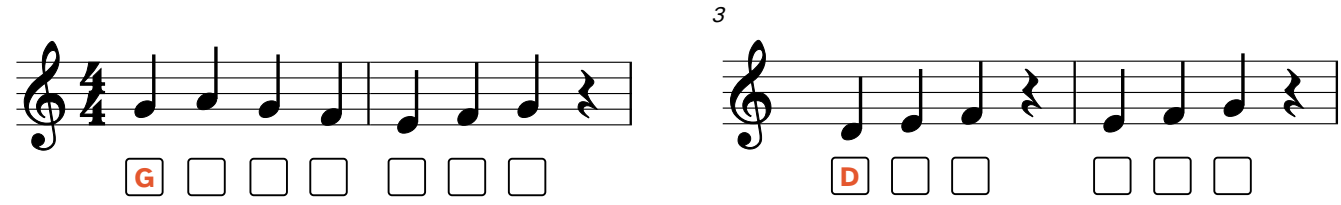
crotchet rest: knock — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●



THE NOTES

The letters are gone now. The first note of each line is given: count up or down from it.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song and forgets one rest (or adds one), or plays the wrong root. Put up your hand when you hear it.

- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

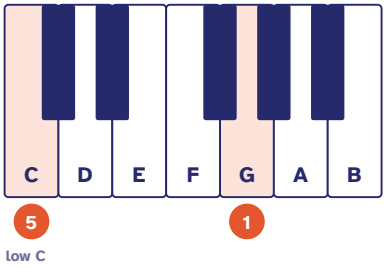
3 The roots

Every bar stands on one note, its root. The left hand plays it; its name sits above the bar.

MEET THE ROOTS

Two roots in this song, C and G, both under the left hand. It never moves: C is 5, G is the thumb.

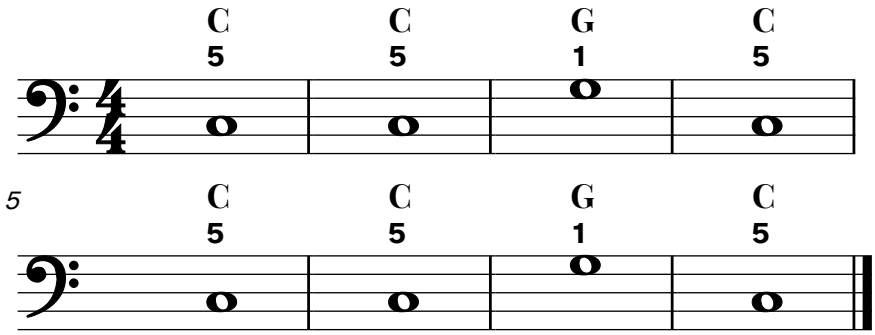
LEFT HAND · AN OCTAVE BELOW MIDDLE C



C: 5, the little finger.
G: 1, the thumb.

THE ROOTS, WITH THEIR NAMES

The left hand's part on its own, each root's name above its bar.



PLAY FROM THE NAMES

Only the names now. Play each bar's root and hold it for four beats while the band plays the tune.

C	C	G	C
C	C	G	C

4 · CHECK

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
From the notes				
From the names				
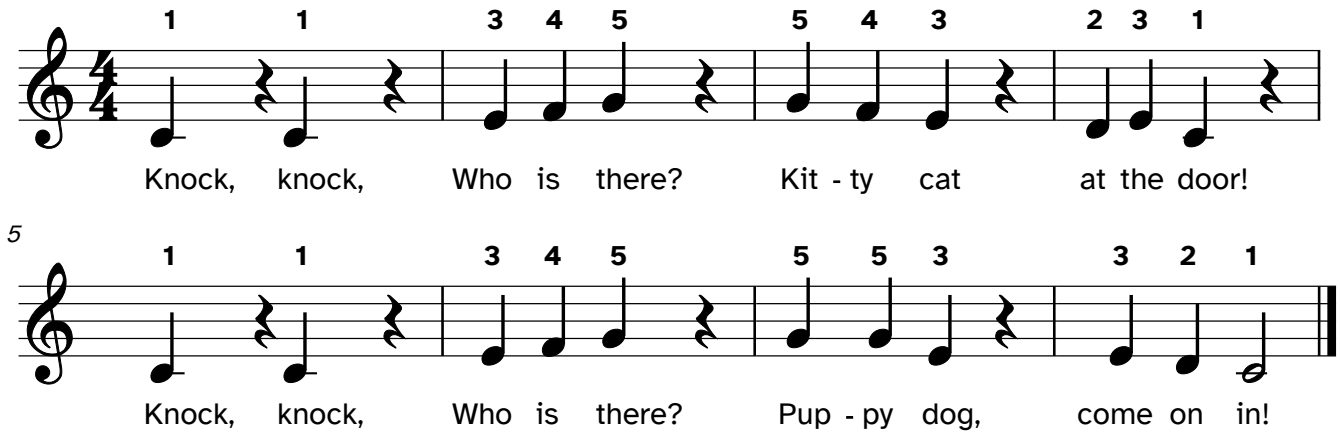
TEACHER ☐ **Pass** ☐ **Not yet**

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

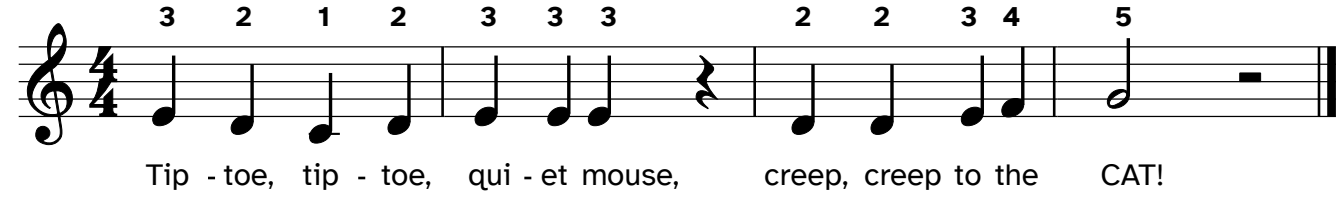
KNOCK, KNOCK

Cheeky: the right hand plays, and the left hand is the door knocker: it knocks on the lid on every rest.



TIPTOE

A peek at Lesson 9: soft, softer… then the last note loud.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Falling slowly: slow and soft**
- ☐ **Bouncy: short and light, like a ball**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand alone, then left hand alone
3. Both hands, with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Knock, Knock** ☐ **Played Tiptoe**